# CORRELATIONS BETWEEN UNEMPLOYMENT AND HOMELESSNESS IN CALIFORNIA

Thayer Doyle

March 11, 2025

# RESEARCH QUESTION: RAPID REVIEW

- My key question is whether there is a correlation between homelessness rates and unemployment rates in California.
- This will require me to calculate the rate of homelessness and unemployment rates in different California counties.

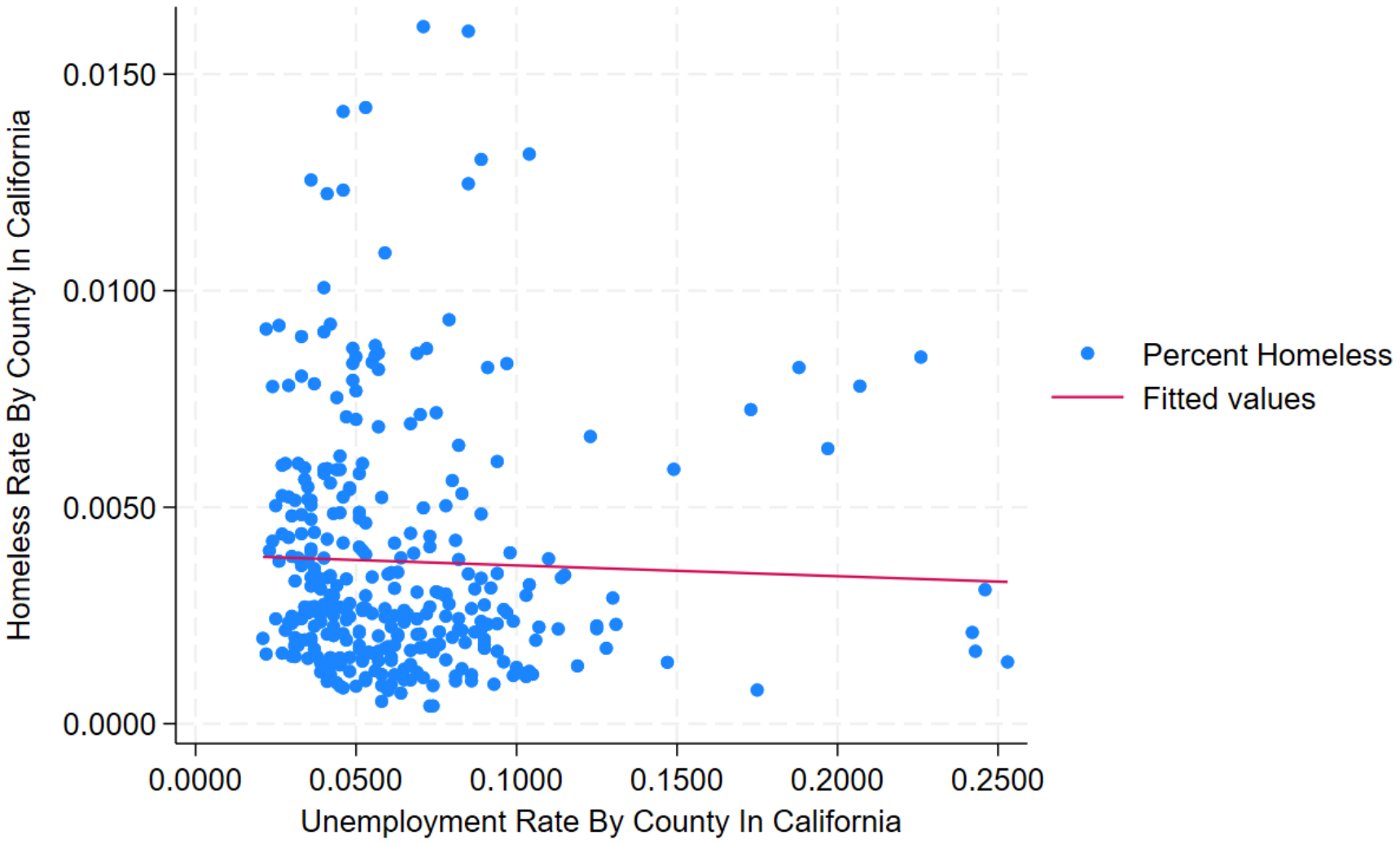
# RESEARCH METHODOLOGY: RAPID REVIEW

- Numbers are needed for each county's homeless population, general population, and unemployment rates.
- This data is collected through the US Census, the Current Population Survey, and annual homelessness counts.
- The data was condensed to calculate the rate of homelessness and unemployment in 30 California counties from 2013 to 2023.

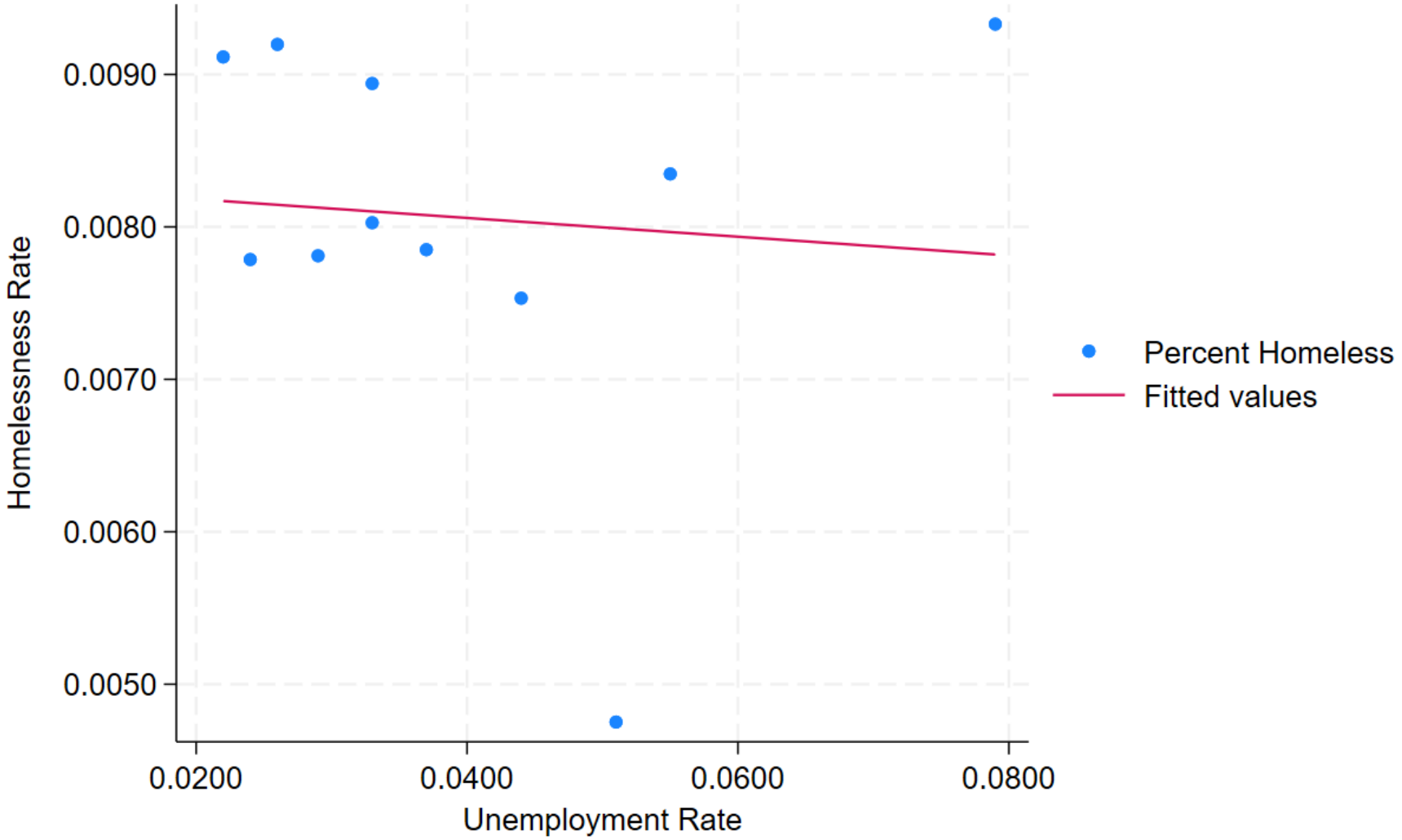
# FINAL RESULTS: WHAT IS THE ANSWER TO MY QUESTION?

- The data has shown that there is minimal correlation between rates of homelessness and rates of unemployment.
  - Even taking into account differences in counties, there is no correlation on a state level.
- This aligns with other papers (Byrne et al. 2013, Fargo et al. 2013) which identify affordable housing as the primary cause.

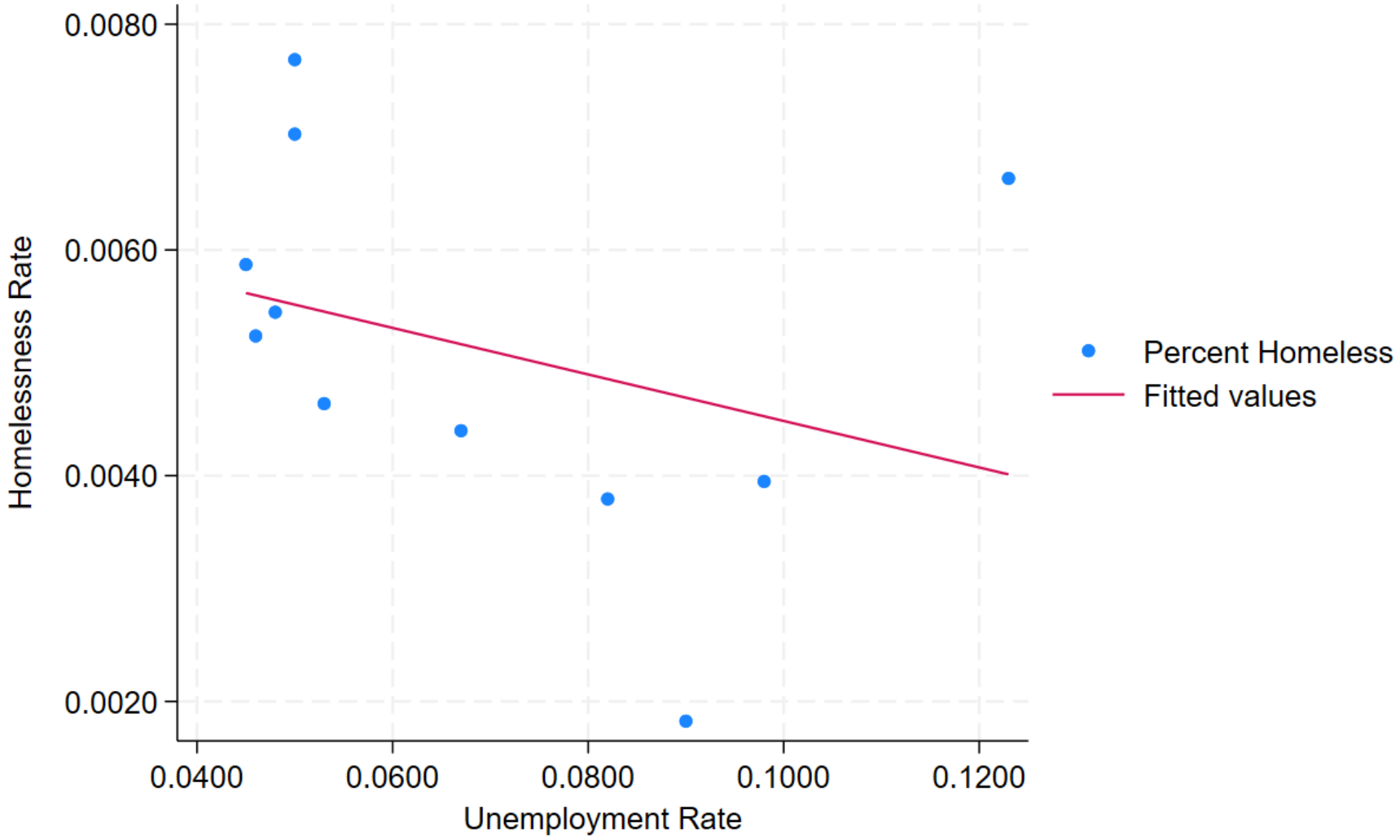
# DATA COLLECTION: GRAPHICAL ILLUSTRATION



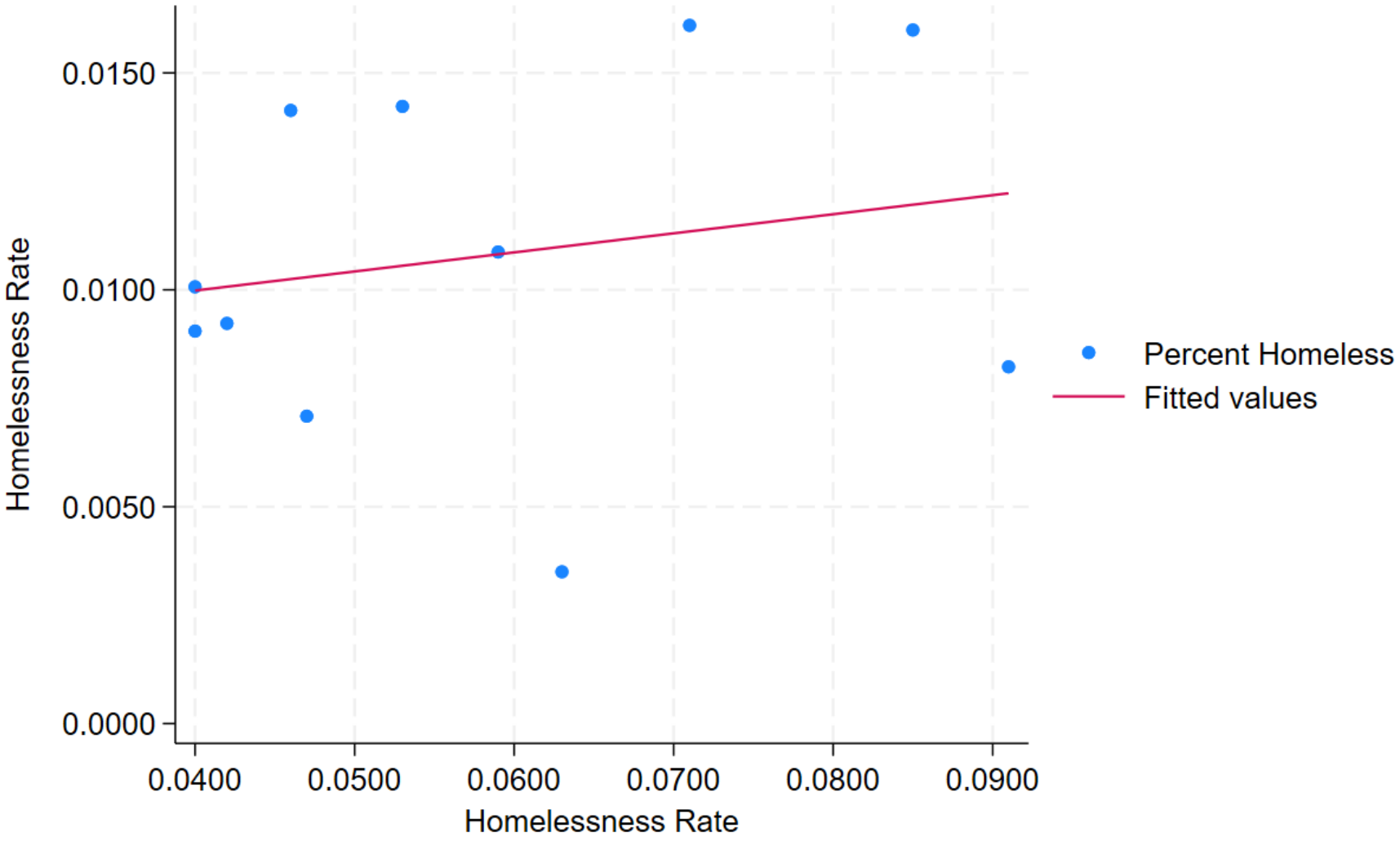
# DATA COLLECTION: SAN FRANCISCO COUNTY



# DATA COLLECTION: LOS ANGELES COUNTY



# DATA COLLECTION: MENDOCINO COUNTY



# RESEARCH RESULTS: IMPLICATIONS AND HURDLES

- The results of this data can help change public perceptions about homelessness.
- Policy makers can focus on different aspects of homelessness considering this data.
- Results could be improved with better data collection.